

peoplestrong[®]

Ethical Code of Conduct Guidelines



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1. Objective

The finality of the Ethical Code of Conduct of PeopleStrong is to establish the guidelines that govern the ethical behavior of all our employees. This Code of Conduct is a guide of action to ensure appropriate conduct in the professional behavior of PeopleStrong employees, in accordance with the laws of the country in which PeopleStrong conducts its activities and with established regulatory systems and relevant cultures respecting their values. This code reflects the principle of care enforced by PeopleStrong for the prevention, detection and elimination of manipulations related to code violations and establishes internal regulatory models that can regularly analyze the risks in cases falling within the scope of this system.

This Ethical code of conduct provides the following benefits:

- Helps in maintaining a moral course through turbulent times: When an organization is guided by ethics it leads to easy solutions of problems that surface.

Aids• in Employee growth: As the employees learn to follow a disciplined route to solve the problems that arise therefore it professionally helps in the growth of the employee.

Fosters• a safe work environment: Our policy aims to foster an environment of trust, ethical behavior, integrity, and excellence.

2. Scope and Eligibility

The Ethical Code of Conduct of PeopleStrong is addressed towards its directors, executives, and, in general, all the employees of the company, irrespective of the positions that they hold or the place where they perform their work. It is mandatory to comply with the guidelines for behavior contained in this Code.

3. About the Policy

The employees shall deal, on behalf of PeopleStrong, with professionalism, honesty, integrity as well as high moral and ethical standards. Such conduct shall be fair and transparent and be perceived to be as such by third parties. PeopleStrong considers that the trust of its shareholders, clients, suppliers and external collaborators, as well as the social environment in which it performs its activity, is based on integrity and responsibility in the professional performance of each one of its employees.

PeopleStrong expects all of its employees to conduct themselves with integrity and responsibility in the performance of their functions. The following clauses lay down the tenants of this policy and indicate the guiding behavior for each of our employee. The present Chief Ethics officer is Mr. Amit Jain, Chief People Officer.

3.1 The components of our code of professional ethics:

We base our business code of ethics on common principles of ethics:

- Respect for others. Treat people as you want to be treated.
- Integrity and honesty. Tell the truth and avoid any wrongdoing to the best of your ability.
- Justice. Make sure you're objective and fair and don't disadvantage others.
- Lawfulness. Know and follow the law – always.
- Competence and accountability. Work hard and be responsible for your work.
- Teamwork. Collaborate and ask for help.

3.2 Ethical Decision Making

The process of making ethical decisions requires:

- Commitment: The desire to do the right thing regardless of the cost
- Consciousness: The awareness to act consistently and apply moral convictions to daily behavior

- **Competency:** The ability to collect and evaluate information, develop alternatives, and foresee potential consequences and risks

The following pointers could be effectively utilized while making an ethical decision:

- There are often grey areas between right and wrong-- ethical and unethical.
- Employees need to be aware of this and realize that proper ethical conduct is always up to them.
- We are empowered to say “NO”, and to do so with dignity in any circumstance where we are asked to do something that we deem unethical.
- As an employee, it is your responsibility to understand and live PeopleStrong Ethical practices.
- Actively discourage unethical behavior, and report when necessary.
- The only way we can be Ethical is by living it all the time.
- Personal relationships between colleagues are based on personal choice. However, to maintain professional standards and avoid conflicts of interest, individuals in such relationships are not permitted to work on the same team or within the same reporting line.

4. Guidelines of Conduct

The Code of Ethics determines specific guidelines for action in the following are:

- **Respect for legality, human rights, and ethical values.**

All the PeopleStrong must comply with laws in force in the countries where they perform their activity, attending to the spirit and finality of the same, along with keeping ethical standards in mind. Also, any action that may damage the reputation of the organization or the government needs to be strictly avoided. The employees of PeopleStrong must act with honesty and integrity ensuring truthfulness in all their actions. No employees are to consciously. In any situations of lack of respect for legality, human rights or ethical values, employees must inform the company via their hierarchical superior.

- **Anti Child Labor.**

Child labor refers to the employment of children in work that is harmful to their

physical or mental development and deprives them of their basic rights. PeopleStrong recognizes the importance of protecting children from exploitation and ensuring their well-being. Here are some key points related to child labor policies in PeopleStrong: **Legal regulations:** PeopleStrong operates within the legal framework of Child Labour (Prohibition and Regulation) Act, 1986. This act prohibits the employment of children below the age of 14 in certain hazardous occupations and processes.

Age requirements: PeopleStrong typically have policy that establish 18 Years as a minimum age for employment.

Verification and documentation: To prevent the employment of underage individuals, PeopleStrong have processes in place to verify the age and identity of potential employees. This may involve requesting documents such as birth certificates, passports, or other government-issued identification.

Supplier responsibility: In addition to our own policies, PeopleStrong also implement measures to ensure that their suppliers and subcontractors uphold similar standards. This includes conducting regular audits and assessments to verify compliance with child labor regulations throughout the supply chain.

Respect People

PeopleStrong strongly refrains any form of physical, psychological, or moral

- harassment or abuse of authority. Any conduct that generates harm to the rights of other employees needs to be avoided. Employees must treat each other with respect and ensure a safe and healthy working environment for all. All employees shall treat their colleagues, superiors, and subordinates with due respect.

Professional development and equal opportunities.

PeopleStrong promotes the professional and personal development of all its employees

- and provides equal opportunities via its policies of action.

Occupational health and safety.

PeopleStrong promotes the adoption of occupational health and safety policies and adopts the measures of prevention always ensuring compliance with regulations in this area.

- **Use and protection of assets.**

PeopleStrong provides its employees with the resources necessary for the performance of their professional activity. All employees must use the resources of the company in a responsible, efficient and suitable manner also they must protect and preserve them from any inappropriate use from which any damages for the interests of the company may be derived.

- **Irregular payments and money laundering.**

PeopleStrong establishes policies to prevent and avoid the making of irregular payments or money laundering.

- **Corporate image and reputation:**

PeopleStrong has invested certain years to build up a reputation of this kind and it certainly is the most valuable asset to preserve. All employees must take the utmost care to preserve the image and reputation of the company in all their professional actions.

- **Loyalty to the company and conflicts of interest:**

Peepzen are expected to avoid any situations that may give rise to a conflict between personal interests and those of the company and are expected to be confront challenging situations with loyalty.

- **Respect for the environment.**

The preservation of the environment is one of the basic principles of action of PeopleStrong.

5. Non-Acceptance of gifts from Clients/ Vendors

- The employees of the Company during the course of interaction with suppliers and customers/clients, shall neither receive nor offer or make, directly and indirectly, any illegal payments, remuneration, gifts, donations, comparable benefits or sexual favors which are intended or perceived to obtain business or uncompetitive favors for the

conduct of its business. However, this is not intended to include gifts of customary nature.

- It is unethical for a peepzen to accept gifts from clients that could be seen as an attempt to influence the judgment or actions related to the project.
- Accepting gifts from vendors could be seen as a conflict of interest that could compromise the integrity of the company and influence the judgement of the procurement team.
- Peepzen should consider their industry's ethical standards and the potential impact of accepting gifts on their reputation and relationships with clients or vendors. If a peepzen decides not to accept gifts, they should communicate this clearly and respectfully to the giver and provide alternative ways for the giver to show appreciation or establish a positive relationship.

6. Anti Bribery – Zero Tolerance

We take a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption and are committed to acting professionally, fairly and with integrity in all our business dealings and relationships, wherever we operate, and to implementing and enforcing effective systems to counter bribery.

1. Objective

The purpose of an anti-bribery policy is to prevent bribery and corruption by having adequate procedures to monitor and identify where and when it may occur.

2. Scope

The purpose of the policy is to: set out the Company's responsibilities, and those of anyone working for and on their behalf, in observing and upholding its position on bribery and corruption in government and non- government (private commercial) dealings.

3. What is not acceptable?

- Give, promise to give or offer, any payment, gift, hospitality or advantage with the expectation or hope that a business advantage will be given or received or to reward a business advantage already given.
- Give, promise to give or offer, any payment, gift or hospitality to a government official, agent or representative to “facilitate” or expedite a routine procedure. • Accept or solicit any payment, advantage, gift or hospitality from a Third Party

that you know, or suspect is being offered with the expectation that it will obtain a business advantage for them

- Threaten or retaliate against, another employee who has refused to commit a bribery offence or who has raised concerns under this Policy.
- Engage in any activity that might lead to a breach of this Policy.

4. Procedure

a) How to raise a concern?

Every person, to whom this policy applies too, is encouraged to raise their concerns about any bribery issue or suspicion of malpractice at the earliest possible stage. If he/ she is unsure whether a particular act constitutes bribery or corruption or if he / she has any other queries, these should be raised with their respective Manager and/or the Vigilance and Ethics Officer.

b) What to do if you are a victim of bribery?

It is the peepzens responsibility to inform / report it to their respective Managers and the Vigilance and Ethics Officer as soon as possible if you are offered a bribe by a third party, you are asked to make one, suspect that this may happen in the future or believe that you are a victim of another form of corruption or other unlawful activity. You must refuse to accept or make the payment from or to a third party, explain our policy against accepting or making such payment and make it clear that the refusal is final and non-negotiable because of this Policy. If you encounter any difficulty making this refusal, you should seek assistance from your manager.

c) Protection

Those who refuse to accept or offer a bribe or those who raise concerns or report another's wrong doing, are sometimes worried about possible repercussions. We encourage openness and will support anyone who raises genuine concerns in good faith under this Policy, even if they turn out to be mistaken. We are committed to ensuring that no one suffers any detrimental treatment as a result of refusing to take part in bribery or corrupt activities or because of reporting

their suspicion in good faith that an actual or potential bribery or other corruption offence has taken place or may take place in the future. If any employee believes that they have suffered any such treatment, they should inform your Manager or the Vigilance and Ethics Officer immediately.

d) Maintaining Accurate Books and Records:

No payment by or on behalf of the PeopleStrong shall be approved or made if any part of the payment is to be used for an unlawful or improper purpose, or for any purpose other than that described by valid documents supporting the payment. No false or misleading entries should be made in any books or financial records of the PeopleStrong for any reason. Any expenses that an employee or third party incurs on PeopleStrong's behalf or in connection with our business shall not be reimbursable unless they are lawful and supported by detailed documentation including, for example, valid invoices or receipts.

7. Ethical Misconduct

The following is an illustrative list of misconducts prohibited by this policy. Below guidelines are not intended to be an all-inclusive list of what conduct and work performance may result in disciplinary action, as circumstances and incidents may vary on a case-to-case basis.

Below is an illustrative list of misconducts prohibited.

- Willful insubordination or disobedience of any lawful and reasonable order of a superior;
- Going on an illegal strike, or abetting, inciting, instigating or acting in furtherance thereof;
- Willful slowing down in performance of work, or abetment or instigation thereof;
- Theft, fraud, or dishonesty in connection with the Employer's business or property, or the theft of property of another employee within the premises of the Employer;
- Taking or giving bribes or any illegal gratification;
- Habitual absence without leave or absence without leave;

- Late attendance on not less than four occasions within a month;
- Habitual breach of Company Policies;
- Reporting to work improperly attired;
- Repetitive tardiness at work;
- Collection without the prior written permission of the Management of any money within the premises of the Employer except as sanctioned by any law for the time being in force;
- Engaging in trade within the premises of the Employer.
- Drunkenness, riotous, disorderly or indecent behavior on the premises of the establishment.
- Commission of any act of subversive of discipline or good behavior on the premises of the establishment.
- Habitual neglect of work, or gross or habitual negligence.
- Habitual breach of any rules or instructions for the maintenance and running of any department, or the maintenance of the cleanliness of any portion of the establishment;
- Disclosing to any unauthorized person any information in regard to the process of the establishment which may come into the possession of the workman in the course of his works;
- Gambling within the premises of the establishment;
- Smoking and spitting on the premises of the establishment where it is prohibited by the employer;
- Unauthorized possession of any lethal weapons in the establishment;
- Sexual harassment which includes unwelcome sexual determined behavior (Whether directly or by implication), such as;
 - Physical contact and advances; or
 - Demand or request for sexual favor; or
 - Sexually colored remarks; or
 - Showing pornography; or

- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or nonverbal conduct of sexual nature.
 - Compliance violations.
 - Integrity violations.
 - Damage/misuse of company/customer property

The misconducts listed are only illustrative in nature and not exhaustive. It just provides examples of conduct that will not be tolerated.

8. Protected Disclosure

Any or all complaints related to the violation of ethical code of conduct should be reported via protected disclosures to the chief ethics officer.

- Protected Disclosures should be reported in writing so as to ensure a clear understanding of the issues raised and should either be typed or written in a comprehensible handwriting in English or in the regional language of the place of the person reporting the concern.
- The Protected Disclosure should be forwarded under a covering letter which shall preferably bear the identity of the person. The Chief Ethics Officer can initiate an investigation independently at their own discretion even on anonymous disclosures.
- Employee can also directly approach Chief Ethics Officer in person to share to submit the disclosure.

9. Acceptance and Compliance with the Code

It is mandatory for all the employees of PeopleStrong to comply with the ethical Code of Conduct. Employees must formally undertake to comply with the Code from day one of them joining the company. PeopleStrong expects a high level of commitment towards compliance with its ethical Code of conduct from all employees, and all employees may be evaluated on the basis of compliance with this Code. Non-fulfilment thereof will be analyzed in accordance with internal procedures, legal regulations and collective agreements in force, and, where applicable, any appropriate penalties shall be applied.

10. Reviews/Investigation

Every concern raised is promptly reviewed/investigated by Chief Ethics Officer, member of the PeopleStrong Human Resources team, or a designate determined by the Chair of the Audit Committee. Concerns raised will only be disclosed to individuals as necessary to complete the review/investigation

or address the situation.

Ethics Council		
Chairperson	Aashay Manake	aashay.manake@peoplestrong.com
Council Members	Prakash Rao	prakash.rao@peoplestrong.com
	Jitendra Nirwani	jitendra.nirwani@peoplestrong.com
	Subhagi Arora	subhagi.arora@peoplestrong.com
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11. Disciplinary action procedure

Acts of misconduct or non-compliance with this code of conduct shall entitle the Company to initiate disciplinary proceedings and could lead to termination of the services of the employee. Any employee who is guilty of any misconduct / acts or discipline which is detrimental to the interest of the company suitable action will be initiated.

If an allegation of gross misconduct is confirmed by investigation and interviews, PeopleStrong HR Technologies reserves the right in such cases to dismiss summarily i.e. without notice.